



1972

Blue Marble

While flying to the Moon, the *Apollo 17* crew took a picture of Earth from 29,000 km (18,000 miles) away. Called the Blue Marble, this photograph was shared around the world.

Also on this day

1835 The first steam railway in Germany, the Bavarian Ludwig Railway, opened.

1909 The first synthetic plastic, named **Bakelite**, was patented by Belgian chemist Leo Baekeland. It was advertised as “the material of 1,000 uses”.

1998 At the age of 17, German-Australian navigator **Jesse Martin** set sail on his solo trip around the globe and set a new world record 11 months later as the youngest person to do so.



December

7



2019

Quadruple flip first

At the ISU Grand Prix of Figure Skating Final in Italy, teenage Russian figure skater Alexandra Trusova performed the first-ever quadruple flip jump by a female athlete in a figure skating competition.

Born this day

1942 **Reginald F Lewis**, Black American entrepreneur. He set up a food company that grew into a billion-dollar business, making him the first Black American to achieve this feat.

1941 Pearl Harbor

Without warning, Japanese military aircraft bombed the US naval base at Pearl Harbor in Hawaii, killing at least 2,000 people. The next day, the USA declared war on Japan, entering World War II.